

I recently read an article on GitHub called "Software as a public good," and it got the wheels in my brain spinning. The author argues something many of us in tech already believe: open source is more than a way to build software—it's part of the foundation that keeps our digital world going.

What really stood out is how open source software supports almost every area, from businesses and governments to nonprofits and global organizations. That reach is important. When software is used everywhere, it becomes more than just code—it turns into a public resource that people rely on, help build, and share responsibility for.

I also liked how the article focused on sustainability. Open source works because people come together to create, maintain, and improve projects, but their efforts aren't always recognized or funded as much as they should be. If open source is so important, then giving back should be a normal part of keeping the ecosystem healthy, not something we do only if there's time.

This ties into something I believe: people do their best work when they feel ownership and connect with others. Open source shows this clearly. It gives everyone a chance to learn, work together, and build something useful that could exceed the efforts or imagination of one person.

Open source is also a practical way to grow. If you want to build your skills, gain confidence, or meet people who care about the same issues, it's a great place to begin. You don't have to start with a big project—even small things like writing documentation, reporting bugs, testing, giving design feedback, or tackling your first issue can help.

That's what makes open source meaningful to me. It's not just about the technology—it's also about the community. It teaches us to build openly, support each other, and create work that lasts beyond our own involvement.

The GitHub article also reminded me that open source has real social value. When we support it, we're not just helping developers—we're also helping the systems, organizations, and communities that depend on it. That matters, especially now when so much digital infrastructure is hidden, fragile, or easy to overlook.

If you want to get involved, the message is simple: start with what you know, share your skills, and be part of something bigger than yourself. Open source makes so much possible.